

SVIE Website

Hostinger Deployment Guide

Node.js + GitHub Auto-Deploy Integration

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Project Details

Property	Value
GitHub Repository	https://github.com/svieblr5/newsitesvieblr.git
Branch	main
Entry Point	server.js
Start Command	node server.js OR npm start
Default Port	3000 (Hostinger may override automatically)
Hosting Type	Hostinger — GitHub Auto-Deploy (Option A)

Step 1 — Prepare GitHub

Your code is already on GitHub. Before every deployment, ensure the latest changes are pushed:

```
git add .
git commit -m "your message"
git push origin main
```

Files that are NOT in GitHub (gitignored) — must be handled separately on the server:

- .env — environment variables (must set manually in hPanel)
- data/ — CMS data files (upload manually via File Manager)
- node_modules/ — installed automatically by npm install

Step 2 — Hostinger hPanel Setup

A. Connect GitHub Repository

- Log in to hPanel at hpanel.hostinger.com
- Go to Websites !' your site !' Git
- Connect your GitHub account if not already linked
- Select repo: svieblr5/newsitesvieblr | Branch: main
- Set deploy path to your site root folder
- e.g. /home/username/htdocs/yourdomain.com/

B. Configure Node.js App

- In hPanel !' Node.js (or Advanced !' Node.js)
- Node.js version: 18.x or 20.x (LTS recommended)
- Application root: /home/username/htdocs/yourdomain.com/
- Application startup file: server.js
- Application URL: your domain name

Step 3 — Set Environment Variables

In hPanel !' Node.js !' Environment Variables, add the following:

Variable	Value
SESSION_SECRET	7cc2e5f9f2313451cef68a2ef7e773d3fc3c862512caca2d7cd562615c9100400b10b051115c2728128c627400b4f447
NODE_ENV	production
PORT	3000 (Hostinger may set this automatically)

IMPORTANT: The .env file is gitignored and will NOT be on the server from GitHub. You MUST add these variables manually in hPanel every time you set up a fresh server.

Step 4 — Upload the data/ Folder (CMS Data)

The data/ folder is gitignored and holds all CMS content, settings, and visitor data. You must upload it manually.

How to upload:

- In hPanel !' File Manager (or use FTP client like FileZilla)
- Navigate to your app root folder
- Create a folder named data/ inside it
- Upload all 5 files from your local: G:\SVIE-redesign\data\

File	Purpose
config.json	CMS settings, admin password hash, email/Telegram config
content.json	Website content — text, images, team, services, etc.
enquiries.json	Contact form submissions received
visitors.json	Visitor tracking data
activity.json	CMS admin activity log

If you skip this step, the server starts with empty data and you will need to reconfigure the CMS from scratch including resetting your admin password.

config.json — Key Values (do NOT lose)

Setting	Value
Admin password hash (bcrypt)	\$2b\$12\$SrdR/ ndncc0A1K62KcEWG0uKFC4bldm7NA_g1SleQ_buNl_k/xyz6
Email notifications to	svie.blr5@gmail.com
Email from	svie.blr5@gmail.com
SMTP host	smtp.gmail.com : 587
Gmail App Password	Stored in emailPass field in config.json

Step 5 — Install Dependencies & Start the App

- In hPanel !' Node.js !' click Run NPM Install
- OR open terminal on the server and run:

```
npm install
```

- Click Restart (or Start) the Node.js app in hPanel
- Check the application log for any startup errors

Step 6 — Upload Images (if needed)

The images/ folder IS tracked in git, so it deploys automatically from GitHub.

If you added new images locally that are not yet committed to git, upload them manually:

- hPanel !' File Manager !' navigate to /images/ in your app root
- Upload any missing image files

Step 7 — Verify Live Site

- Open your domain in the browser — homepage should load
- Go to /admin — log in with CMS admin credentials
- Verify content loads correctly from CMS
- Test the contact form (check email notifications)
- Visit /admin/visitor-dashboard.html to check visitor tracking

Normal Re-Deploy Workflow (after initial setup)

Every time you make changes to the code:

```
# 1. On your local machine (G:\SVIE-redesign)
git add .
git commit -m "describe your change"
git push origin main

# 2. In hPanel !' Git !' click Pull (or it auto-deploys)

# 3. In hPanel !' Node.js !' click Restart
# (only needed if you changed server.js)
```

You do NOT need to re-upload the data/ folder or reset env variables during normal re-deploys. Only code files change via GitHub.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
App won't start / crashes	Check SESSION_SECRET env var is set in hPanel
CMS shows empty content	Upload data/content.json via File Manager
Cannot log in to /admin	Upload data/config.json with correct password hash
502 / 503 error	npm install not run, or wrong startup file (must be server.js)
Port conflict	Remove PORT from env vars — let Hostinger set it automatically
Images missing on live site	Commit images to git and push, or upload via File Manager
Email notifications not working	Verify config.json has correct Gmail App Password
Visitor data not saving	Check data/ folder exists and has write permissions (chmod 755)

Local File Paths Reference

Item	Local Path
Project root	G:\SVIE-redesign\
Data folder	G:\SVIE-redesign\data\
Environment file	G:\SVIE-redesign\.env
Server entry point	G:\SVIE-redesign\server.js
Admin panel	G:\SVIE-redesign\admin\
Main stylesheet	G:\SVIE-redesign\styles.css